10.1 Overview of the application

Our AI interview assistant is designed to help job seekers prepare for interviews by simulating realistic interview scenarios with a large language model (LLM)–powered interviewer. The application provides personalized practice, immediate feedback, and the ability to review past performances. We'll start by looking at the core features that define the user experience.

Project code: interview-assistant

The code for this example project is in the ch10/interview-assistant folder. You can use that example by running this command in the root folder of the project repository:

```
$ npm run dev -w ch10/interview-assistant
```

You'll need the Google API key, Upstash Redis REST URL, Upstash Redis REST token, and Clerk.js authentication credentials to access their respective REST APIs. These are configured as environment variables:

```
// .env
GEMINI_API_KEY=<GOOGLE_AI_SECRET_KEY>
UPSTASH_REDIS_REST_URL=<UPSTASH_REDIS_REST_URL>
UPSTASH_REDIS_REST_TOKEN=<UPSTASH_REDIS_REST_TOKEN>
NEXT_PUBLIC_CLERK_PUBLISHABLE_KEY=<CLERK_PUBLIC_KEY>
CLERK_SECRET_KEY=<CLERK_PRIVATE_KEY
```

Instructions on how to set up and create secret keys for Google AI and Upstash Redis are provided in the appendix.

10.1.1 Key features

Let's explore the key features of this application.

AUTHENTICATION WITH CLERK

Users must authenticate with Clerk.js before accessing the interview application. This ensures user session data is securely stored in Redis and allows for control over API credit usage. We require all users to authenticate to the application before they use its features. Figure 10.1 shows a screenshot of the login page.

CHOOSING AN INTERVIEW TYPE

Once logged in, users begin their experience by selecting an interview type. The application offers two primary paths:

- *Custom interview*—This option allows users to tailor the interview experience to their specific needs by submitting a custom title and job description that will be used in preparing the interview questions. Figure 10.2 shows the UI of the main interview preparation page, where users can customize the job description.